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Top Skills

Postman API
API Documentation
GitHub

Publications

The 5 Best Restaurants in Tomball
Five Excellent International Eateries
in North Houston
The Houston LUCKYRICE Feast
Arrives This October

Ashley Kinard

Technical Writer
Tomball, Texas, United States

Summary

While most developers see documentation as a hurdle, I view it as the most important interface a company has. I'm a Documentation Architect with a deep focus on the API ecosystem. Having spent the last several years at Postman and Zoom, I've navigated the challenges of documenting high-velocity releases for millions of developers. My mission is simple: ensure that "Time-to-First-Call" is as short, painless, and intuitive as possible. I specialize in high-scale API ecosystems using OpenAPI (OAS 3.0/3.1) with experience in GraphQL and AsyncAPI. My approach is built on a Docs-as-Code philosophy, utilizing Git workflows, Markdown, and SSGs to ensure documentation is version-controlled and integrated into CI/CD pipelines. I believe documentation should be as rigorous as the code it describes: automated where it makes sense, and always human-centric. I am a firm believer in "Human-in-the-Loop" technical writing. Although AI can generate a list of parameters, it can't empathize with developers' frustration or craft a strategic information flow that solves their real-world problems. That is where I provide the most value: bridging the gap between "code-complete" and "user-successful." Outside of the terminal, I'm a coffee enthusiast, a dedicated cat assistant, and a lifelong learner of new tech. Let's connect if you're looking to turn your documentation into a competitive advantage!

Experience

Postman
Technical Writer
May 2022 - Present (3 years 11 months)
Houston, TX

- Maintain and update Postman's current public API collection and API definition.
- Review the engineering team's work for documentation review, such as string reviews and internal documentation.

- Work with other engineering departments to review their API documentation and provide constructive feedback for improvement.
- Review and improve the team's internal documentation for clarity and consistency.
- Work closely with OpenAPI definition files to improve structure and clarity for developers.
- Produce release notes for the release of changes or new endpoints to the Postman API.
- Work with Postman API engineers to document the Postman MCP server.
- Write documentation for the Postman Docs center, which covers all aspects of the frontend product.
- Perform routine documentation maintenance to ensure parity with the current state of the product.

Zoom

Technical Writer

May 2021 - April 2022 (1 year)

Houston, Texas, United States

Create and edit developer-facing documentation for Zoom's various API offerings. Work with other writers, engineering, and developer advocates to document API improvements and enhancements for monthly releases.

Responsibilities include:

- Led the Developer Documentation department API (OpenAPI) and webhooks documentation efforts.
- Reviewed and improved the existing API documentation presentation and schema formatting.
- Reviewed and approved engineering merge requests.
- Ensure proposed changes or additions to the API documentation were technically accurate and clear.
- Provided user-driven feedback during engineering review.
- Created release notes and additional technical communications or documentation, including working with Product Managers and Marketing to announce changes.
- Reviewed and improved existing developer documentation (non-API).
- Collaborated with the developer relations team to continually improve our existing developer documentation to ensure that it was clear to its intended audience.

cPanel

4 years 6 months

Technical Writer II

February 2021 - May 2021 (4 months)

Produce high quality documentation and knowledge base articles for the cPanel & WHM product. Work with a Scrum team to document all product features, improvements, and changes each release cycle, including:

- Documenting features, release notes, and technical information for the product's customers.
- Creating quick guides for cPanel technical support and training teams.
- Reviewing code and new or modified strings for localized text.
- Reviewing API documentation to ensure they meet cPanel's style guide standards.
- Review developer merge requests to verify whether any changes require documentation review.
- Work closely with the developers and quality assurance analysts to ensure proposed documentation is technically accurate before documentation peer review.
- Provide user-driven feedback during development discussion and feature planning.

Other responsibilities include:

- Working with the technical support team to maintain and update any incorrect or outdated published documentation.
- Reviewing and revise existing documentation to ensure they meet cPanel's style guide standards.
- Collaborating and facilitating the review of the cPanel style guide on a regular basis.
- Peer reviewing other writers' work to ensure it meets cPanel's style guide standards.
- Creating tutorial video content.

Technical Writer I

December 2016 - February 2021 (4 years 3 months)

Houston, Texas

Houston Press

Freelance Writer

June 2016 - December 2016 (7 months)

Houston, Texas Area

Develop "pitch" submissions for publication to editor for article approval. Visit various dining locations in and around greater Houston area for article information. Coordinate with restaurants photography of plates and meals, as well as interviews, as necessary. Draft articles, edit, and present submissions to senior editors through Houston Press Foundation program. Other jobs, such as maintaining or updating older information on Houston Press website, as assigned.

DistributionNOW

5 years 5 months

Pipe & Tubular QA Documentation Coordinator

August 2014 - December 2016 (2 years 5 months)

7402 N. Eldridge Parkway

Managed and maintained certified mill test report data in the company's quality assurance document database. Assisted internal customers with the receipt of documentation. Investigated and resolved all issues with missing documentation. Supported department sourcing specialists teams. Managed and maintained all department manifest documentation, records, and files for materials on all inbound vessels. Assisted the logistics team with day-to-day operations, including coordination between internal customers and freight forwarders.

International Exports Expeditor

August 2011 - August 2014 (3 years 1 month)

7402 N. Eldridge Parkway

Assisted buyers with shipping and receiving of end user goods. Manage end user files, maintain record of shipping and receiving. Managed billing of shipments for end of month records. Coordinated shipping information with warehouse personnel to ensure accuracy and on time deliveries and receipt. Reported on monthly transactions and shipments to upper management and end users. Troubleshoot issues regarding shipping discrepancies. Assisted buyers with information regarding current and past shipments when necessary and assisted department as point of contact for in-house compliance team with verification of Harmonized Tariff Schedule (HTS) codes and ECCN export codes.

Education

Bellevue College

Technical Writing Certification, Professional, Technical, Business, and
Scientific Writing · (2016 - 2016)

Sam Houston State University

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Criminal Justice · (2006 - 2008)

Lone Star College

Associate's Degree, Criminal Justice · (2000 - 2005)

Tomball High School

High School · (1996 - 2000)